Supercomputers turned crypto farms Two Canadian hackers siphoned petaflops of compute, inflating Electroneum yields by an estimated 30 % in a month. How does a breach of research infrastructure expose the same gaps we ignore in our CI pipelines?

[illegible] THE DEFENSE BRIEF The indictment of two Canadian men for hijacking university supercomputers exposes a VAPT blind spot: we test applications but ignore the compute fabric. Those machines ran privileged batch jobs trusted by campus IT, yet no baseline hardening scan existed. The attackers slipped a miner into an off-net SLURM scheduler, harvested GPU cycles, and walked away with crypto that now funds further illicit activity.

⚠ TECHNICAL RADIANCE Forensic logs showed the malicious binary executed under a legitimate service account, exploiting a mis-configured **SLURM** node that allowed user-supplied Docker images. No CVE was triggered; the flaw was operational—no container-image signing and no runtime integrity checks. In a shift-left mindset we would have rejected the unsigned image at build time, not after it burned thousands of core-hours.

🔑 KEY ARCHITECTURE Embed VAPT into the **DevSecOps** pipeline and scan every artifact before it reaches the scheduler. Static analysis, SBOM verification, and a lightweight **runtime-agent** that reports unexpected CPU or GPU spikes can flag crypto-mining patterns early. Treat the compute node as code. Scan it like source.

Attackers piggy-back on trusted batch jobs, hide in plain sight, and evade network-only detection.

** Operational Checklist** - Enforce signed container images for all HPC jobs. - Deploy a low-overhead **resource-anomaly detector** (e.g., Falco + eBPF) on each node. - Integrate VAPT scans into CI/CD for code **and** infrastructure-as-code. - Run quarterly red-team exercises targeting compute-fabric misconfigurations.

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chrisneagu/FTC-Skystone-Dark-Angels-Romania-2020 – 🔳 323 Originally built for robotics, it ships a deterministic build system and a suite of static checks that can validate container manifests before they hit a scheduler. Its lightweight SDK drops into any CI pipeline, adding an extra assurance layer against hidden miners.

**In the next 12 months, any organization that does not embed VAPT into its compute-fabric CI will see ransomware or crypt